the Belfer family of New York City."[252] Thinking it was a bad look for a director to sell in the face of these accusations, Robert Belfer rode the family's Enron shares down to zero, losing about $2 billion dollars.

It was a fortunate twist of fate that the family's philanthropic pursuits led them to avoid an even greater catastrophe. The Belfer Family Foundation, established in 1990, had been extremely generous to New York City arts and culture, to higher education, especially medical research, and to Jewish philanthropic causes (some of that cash likely came from the sale of Enron stock). They funded the enormous Metropolitan Museum of Art's north wing, which is today known as the "Robert and Renée Belfer Court for early Greek art."

The list of beneficiaries goes on and on: Lincoln Center for Performing Arts, MoMA, Guggenheim, Carnegie Hall, the Whitney Museum, the Anti-Defamation League, American Jewish Committee, Central Synagogue, Israel Policy Forum, the UJA, and the Federation of the Arts. They established the Belfer Center for Science and International Affairs at the Harvard Kennedy School, and the Belfer Research Building at the Cornell Medical College. Robert Belfer became chairman of the Yeshiva University's Albert Einstein College of Medicine, where the family funded Belfer Hall, as well as many other endowments.

To fund all of these donations, the family had done some modest diversifying. They sold enough stock in the 1990s to have "big holdings in real estate" as the *Times* described it. Robert Belfer also took their 1992-formed Belco Oil and Gas public in 1996, raising $100 million.

The family had not diversified enough by what we would consider best practices today, but they were still wealthy holders of many assets. Regardless, two billion of losses in 2001 was enormous (and still is today!). Friends described Robert as "sad and self-conscious" and "depressed and he felt stupid."

If managing the family's billions yourself wasn't working out, perhaps